

THE PROBLEM

CampusProof

Real university photos — each with a source, a date and a trust level.

Applicants pick universities they **can't visit**. Official sites show polished marketing, and real photos are scattered, duplicated, outdated — or of another place. Image search never says **which photo to trust**.

Applicants 16–19, Kazakhstan & Central Asia

Parents

Admissions advisors



Where is this photo from?



When was it taken?



Is it really this university?

27 %

of the most promising open-source images we examined were rejected: duplicates, logos & documents, tiny files, portraits, another institution's name — 137 of 513, across 14 universities.



OUR SOLUTION

Type a university — get a verified visual profile

Proof, not pictures: an honest “not found” beats someone else's photo.

PROBLEM

Unverifiable, scattered campus photos



CAMPUSPROOF

Evidence pipeline over open data, web search and AI



USER ACTION

Type a name — typos are fine



RESULT

Campus, dorms, classrooms, libraries, city
— sorted and checked

✓ Verified

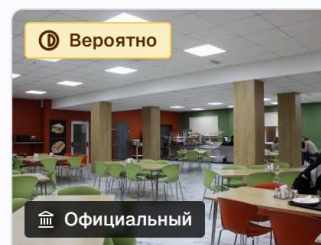
🟡 Likely

? Unconfirmed · hidden

Общежития 5

Здания общежитий, комнаты, общие зоны

Вероятно 5



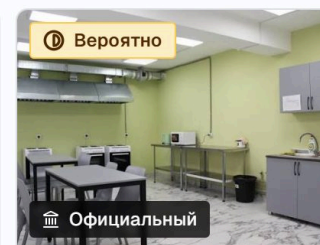
kbtu.edu.kz
получено 19.09.2026

Проверено по миниатюре



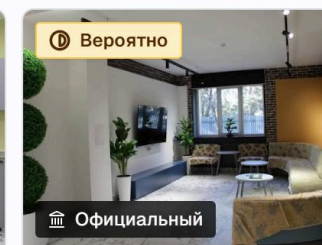
kbtu.edu.kz
получено 19.09.2026

Проверено по миниатюре



kbtu.edu.kz
получено 19.09.2026

Проверено по миниатюре



kbtu.edu.kz
получено 19.09.2026

Проверено по миниатюре

Live on production — KBTU dormitories, from the university's own site, each with source, date and trust tier. UI in Russian: built for Kazakhstan & Central Asia.

01 Smart search: typos, acronyms, Cyrillic; a pick-list if ambiguous

03 Trust tier computed from recorded evidence

02 Clickable source, typed date and license on every photo

04 Honest gaps + a list of what was filtered out and why

From a name to proof in seconds

1 Type a name · INPUT

Найдите университет. Посмотрите кампус, общежития и аудитории — с источниками и проверкой каждого снимка.

→ Найти

Например: MSU Назарбаев Университет Harvard University

“КБТУ”, “MSU”, even “Nazarbaev Univercity” work.

2 Live pipeline · PROCESS

▼ Как собран профиль

✓ Поиск кандидатов: 135	✓ Загрузка загружено: 36	✓ Дубли осталось: 36	✓ Проверка фото: 31 · отсеяно: 5	✓ Профиль
----------------------------	-----------------------------	-------------------------	-------------------------------------	-----------

ИСТОЧНИКИ

✓ Википедия 2

✓ Веб-поиск 54

✓ Openverse 2

✓ Wikimedia Commons 79

✓ Визуальная проверка 36

135 candidates from Commons, web search and Openverse → 36 checked → **31 photos, 5 rejected**.
Built in 1.9 s (sources cached).

3 Evidence decides · AI + RULES

✓ Проверено

Kazakh-British Technical University, Almaty (P1180219)

Есть сильное доказательство, что снимок относится именно к этому университету, и нет противоречий.

ПОЧЕМУ ТАКОЙ УРОВЕНЬ

📄 Происхождение — где и кем опубликован снимок

✓ В категории университета на Wikimedia Commons

📍 Геометка — где сделан снимок по координатам из фото

✓ Снято в 117 м от кампуса

Gemini describes the image; **code scores evidence**: 100 pts → ✓ Verified.

4 Verified profile · OUTPUT

Кампус 7

● Проверено 5 ● Вероятно 2

Корпуса, территория, входы, виды сверху

✓ Проверено

✓ Проверено

✓ Проверено

✓ Проверено

8 sections, **4 filters**, map and compare — every photo one click from its source.

RESULT 31 photos, each with a source, a date and a trust tier. A saved profile reopens in about 0.4 s.

AI observes. Code decides.

A streaming pipeline on free and open APIs — every stage has a timeout.

PRODUCT LAYER

Browser · any device

No accounts; IPs only hashed for rate limits

Next.js 16 · React 19

UI + API routes on Vercel, Node.js 24

Server-Sent Events

Stages and photos stream as they're ready

Tailwind 4 · shadcn/ui

Accessible UI, dark mode; Leaflet + OSM map

PIPELINE · TYPESCRIPT · ONE PATH FOR EVERY UNIVERSITY

1 Resolve

Local index of 1,041 universities + live Wikidata

2 Gather

Commons, Wikipedia · Serper · Openverse, in parallel

3 Download

SSRF-safe fetch, sharp resize, EXIF geotags

4 Deduplicate

Perceptual hash (dHash) + same-scene check

5 Observe · Gemini

Image type, visible text, category — zod-checked JSON

6 Score · rules

Points per evidence → tier; deterministic, tested

7 Describe · Gemini

3–5 sentences from sources only, each cited

8 Assemble

Coverage per section, filtered-out list

DATA & QUALITY

Upstash Redis

14-day profile cache, source & model answers, rate limits

Guardrails

27 s deadline, per-source timeouts, ?simulate= outages

291 automated tests

vitest; CI gates every pull request

Production audits

Smoke test + evidence audit of 1,105 photos

✓ AI never assigns scores or tiers

✓ No people identification

✓ Official APIs & open data, no scraping

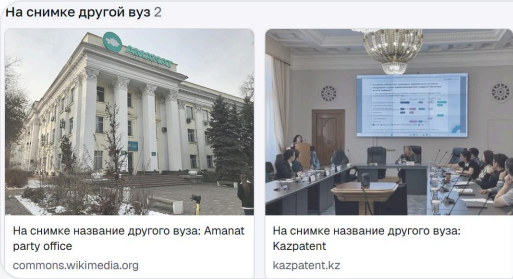
✓ No per-university special cases

Image search shows pictures. We show proof.

The same questions — answered on every single photo.

QUESTION	IMAGE SEARCH / OFFICIAL SITE	CAMPUSPROOF
Where is it from?	✗ A thumbnail, provenance unknown	✓ Clickable source page, license, author
When was it taken?	✗ Undated, or a date of unknown meaning	✓ Typed date: taken, uploaded, published
Is it this university?	✗ A guess by the viewer	✓ Trust tier from evidence, every point visible
Noise	✗ Duplicates, stock, renders, other places	✓ Removed before display, reason shown
Missing data	✗ Filled with anything that looks close	✓ Honest empty section: “couldn't confirm”
Marketing vs reality	✗ Only what the university chose to show	✓ Official and independent, side by side

Real catch, KBTU profile: photos showing “Amanat party office” and “Kazpatent” signs were flagged by the visual check and moved to “Filtered out”, with the reason shown to the user.



Trust you can audit — already working

Measured on production, with sample size and date. Targets are marked as targets.

27 / 27

smoke-test queries passed:
typos, ambiguity, garbage,
outages

2.6 s

median to a finished profile
(sources cached; cold runs
9–20 s)

FOR APPLICANTS & PARENTS

See real dorms, classrooms and campus before applying — and know which photo to trust.

FOR ADVISORS & PLATFORMS

Shareable, source-linked profiles; a JSON profile endpoint already exists for integration.

FOR THE INDUSTRY

A transparency standard for visual claims, built on open data with authors and licenses credited.

NEXT KPIs · TARGETS, NOT YET MEASURED

“Verified” precision on a labeled test set $\geq 90\%$ · category accuracy $\geq 85\%$ · p50/p90 cold latency · user reports per 1,000 photos

0

score/evidence mismatches in
1,105 photos of 42 profiles

365 / 365

“official site” claims confirmed
against Wikidata

✓ Verified 30.1 %

🟡 Likely 53.9 %

? 15.9 %

Trust tiers of 1,105 photos in 42 saved profiles. Sources: docs/qa-report-2026-09-19.md, eval/results/2026-09-19-evidence-audit.md

Built in 72 hours as parallel lanes

LOCUS Startup Hackathon 2026 · Case 01 “Visual University Profile”.

P1

Amirkhan Sagyndyk
Pipeline & Verification

Streaming pipeline, resolver, sources, Gemini integration, scoring rules, cache and rate limits.
github.com/Amir10202010

P4

[Name]
Product & UI

Profile interface: evidence dialog, filters, map, compare, error states; QA smoke tests, README, pitch.
github.com/aldiyaraizhigitov

P3

[Name]
Data

University index built from Wikidata SPARQL — 1,041 universities with names, aliases and domains.
github.com/Chelovek12346

?

[Name]
[Role]

Fourth team member — fill in or remove this card.

Contract-first

Typed interfaces and a working skeleton from hour one, so lanes never blocked each other

291 tests

Every change shipped as a small pull request, merged only with green CI

Open by default

Public repository; AI coding assistant use disclosed in the README

From a working MVP to a trust layer for campus media

NOW · LIVE

Working MVP

- Search with typos, acronyms and a pick-list
- 8 sections, 4 filters, trust tiers with evidence
- Filtered-out list, map, compare, saved profiles
- Graceful degradation, tested on production

NEXT · PLANNED

Prove accuracy

- Labeled test set + public accuracy page
- Reuse detector: the same image on a stock site or another university
- User reports on photos as a scoring signal
- More local sources for Kazakhstan & Central Asia

FUTURE · EXPLORE

Scale the trust layer

- Profile API for admissions advisors and education platforms
- Kazakh and English interface
- More countries and university systems
- Campus tour from geotagged photos

MVP · now



Pilot with admissions advisors



Applicants



Platform integrations



New regions

From campus photos you have to **take on faith** — to proof you can **check in one click**.

Try it: campusproof.vercel.app Code: github.com/Amir10202010/campusproof